generator each. This simple adherence to keeping the interests of the men first and foremost left a deep impression on me.

A little later, there was some official work to be done in Delhi. The work was of a little sensitive and slightly unpleasant nature and would normally have been done by someone more senior, as it involved escorting an officer (senior to me) under armed guard to the Base Hospital at Delhi. The Commandant though, looked at it differently. When he had finished explaining the complexities of the job, he said that once I had finished the work, I could take a few days off before returning. That was music to my ears and Veena got a nice surprise when I turned up unannounced a few days later. By then, both Veena and Isha were well enough to travel and we all returned together to Fatehgarh, to a new house that had just been allotted to me. One of the first things we did was to buy a fridge, an inescapable necessity to keep the milk fresh. We didn't have enough money to buy one outright, so we bought it on instalments from a dealership in Farrukhabad, run by Kuku Singh, a Sikh gentleman. I also secured a gas connection and we bought a two-burner stove from the gas agency. Little by little, we built up our household, saving whatever we could to fund our next purchase. I had the joy and pleasure of seeing Isha grow up and being there for every milestone, from turning over to sitting up, from crawling to standing. The baby babble and first words. I thanked my stars that Col Kapur had sent me to the Training Centre with its relaxed routine, rather than the hurly-burly of an active formation, that too a new raising. Perhaps the fact that he too had been at the Regimental Centre, gave him the vision of what would be best for me.

Soon after joining me at Fatehgarh, Veena was offered a job as a primary teacher in the Army Public School, for a princely salary of Rs 350 per month. Although Isha was only

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